

back in time to a state where things were fine. It would typically involve software development and testing various applications and operating systems.

Remote accessibility

This one feature may not mean a lot to most people who plan to use virtual machines on their home computers for fun and experimentation. It may, however, be immensely useful to those who want to use VMs for remotely working on their computers. For example, if you have multiple computers at home and want to work with a virtual machine installed on your desktop PC from inside the coziness of a blanket on your laptop, this feature is for you. It may also be a great way to control the VM installed on your home PC from your office or vice versa.

Though the remote access feature is majorly useful for work, it could also be a life-saver even if you're using it for experimentation. Say, you need an important file such as a passport photo copy for some urgent government work. Though most popular virtualization software today have this feature, it's best to understand the risks you're up against when using it. Anyone is allowed to access your virtual machines unless you have some mechanism to protect access.

Guest add-ons – tools and drivers

Guest add-ons or tools are a set of drivers actually provided by the virtualization software for ease of use of virtual machines. This typically involves the display driver acting as a key component. They also facilitate better network operations inside the virtual machine, faster responses to input, faster processing, etc. Unless the software has these add-ons, don't expect a very pleasant experience. One of the biggest lags would be with the display, which

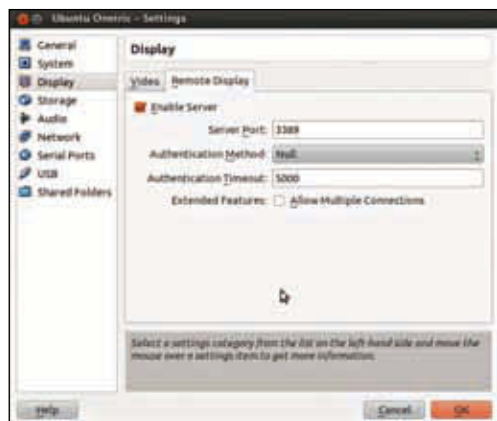


Figure 4: Remote display options in VirtualBox